

Rafael Montero Salazar

Software Engineer — Full-Stack Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 14+ years of experience across QA, front-end, and full-stack development, including 6+ years building production applications with Vue.js, React, and JavaScript ES6.
- Strong backend skills with Node.js/Express and Java Spring Boot.
- Delivered for large enterprise clients — including Maxar Technologies and Subaru — across geospatial, automotive, and global identity systems.
- Experienced integrating AI tooling (Cursor, Ollama, LangChain/LangGraph) into development workflows to accelerate delivery.
- Manages Docker-based server infrastructure (nginx, MariaDB, Redis, AWS) as a developer/sysadmin, including a self-run WordPress hosting business since 2017.
- Prioritizes client visibility into the development process and clear, well-defined requirements flow across teams and meetings.
- Fully remote-capable and comfortable in direct client-facing roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: Vue.js, React, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Vanilla JS, Adobe Experience Manager (AEM)

Backend: Node.js, Express, Java, Spring Boot

Databases: SQL database design and normalization, MariaDB/MySQL, MongoDB (NoSQL — collections and documents)

Frontend Tooling & Libraries: npm, Yarn, Vite, Tailwind CSS, Docusaurus, TanStack Query, Axios

Styling & CSS: SCSS, SASS, Flexbox, CSS Grid, Box Model, CSS Modifiers, Responsive/Mobile-First Design, Accessibility (a11y)

Software Engineering Practices: Design Patterns, SOLID Principles, Clean Code, RESTful API Design, Component-Based Architecture, Code Reviews / Pull Requests

Version Control: Git, GitHub, Git Flow, Trunk-Based Development

Communication & Collaboration: Client visibility into development process, clear requirements definition, cross-team meeting facilitation

Agile & Collaboration: Scrum sprints, Jira, Confluence

AI & Tooling: Responsible use of AI-assisted development tools — Cursor, Claude Code, VS Code + Ollama (local models), LangChain, LangGraph, AI agent development

Infrastructure / DevOps: Linux server administration, Bash scripting, Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes (working knowledge), CI/CD pipelines, nginx, UFW, APT, Snap, SSH key-based security, Redis, Let's Encrypt SSL, Grafana (familiarity), VPS administration (Vultr, OVHcloud), AWS (EC2, Lightsail, S3, IAM)

QA & Testing: Manual and automated testing, unit and integration testing (Jest, Vitest, JUnit), Storybook, stubs, dependency mocking, spyOn

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer — Gorilla Logic

Project: Internal Project

- Developed React and Node.js applications integrating AI agents built with LangChain and LangGraph.
- Used AI-assisted development tools, including Cursor and VS Code with local Ollama models, to improve development speed and code quality.

Project: Global Identity Platform (Automotive Enterprise Client)

Sep 2023 – Feb 2026

- Maintained and enhanced global Account Identity pages on the Azure platform for a large automotive enterprise client, supporting users across the Americas, Asia, Europe, and the UAE.
- Built and maintained front-end features using Vanilla JavaScript within a large-scale, multi-region enterprise application.
- Collaborated with teams across other regions to propose and execute technical solutions.

- Implemented Adobe Analytics tagging tailored by region, country, and language.

Client: Maxar Technologies

Aug 2022 – Sep 2023

- Contributed to SecureWatch, a geospatial platform delivering Earth imagery and geospatial information, using Vue.js on the front end and Java Spring on the back end.
- Worked within a containerized development environment using Docker and Kubernetes as part of the team's deployment workflow.
- Participated in the development of the Maxar Developer Portal using Vue.js and Docusaurus.
- Developed client-facing communication skills through direct participation in client meetings, providing visibility into the development process and proposing effective technical solutions.

Web Developer — Accenture

Aug 2018 – Aug 2022

- Worked on the Subaru.com website for client Subaru, part of a client engagement spanning nearly 8 years across QA and development roles.
- Contributed to a front-end redesign project built with Vue.js and Adobe Experience Manager (AEM).

QA Analyst — Accenture

Jan 2015 – Aug 2018

- Performed manual and automated testing for the Subaru.com website.

QA Analyst — Critech Research

Nov 2011 – Jan 2015

- Conducted manual testing of medical devices for clients including Mindray, Bayer, and Abbott.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS & SIDE BUSINESS

Founder — Web Hosting & Infrastructure (Self-Employed)

2017 – Present

- Run a part-time side business hosting WordPress sites in Docker containers across multiple VPS providers (Vultr, OVHcloud, AWS), including Eurekafoods, Boutique Galatea, Alcala Novias, and Lucci Boutique.
- Administer Linux servers end-to-end: nginx configuration, UFW firewall rules, and package management via APT and Snap.
- Harden server access with SSH key-based authentication and IP banning/blocking for unauthorized access attempts.
- Use Cloudflare as CDN and proxy for performance, security, and traffic management.

Full-Stack Developer — Boutique Galatea (Wedding Dress Management System)

2018 – Present

- Built and maintain a full-stack application using Vue 3 and Java Spring Boot 3 to manage wedding dress inventory and operations for a major Costa Rica retail store.
- In production since 2018; upgraded to the latest framework versions in 2024.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Software Systems

Universidad Latina, Heredia, Costa Rica — 2007 – 2011

Licenciatura in Software Systems, emphasis in QA/QC (coursework completed, thesis pending)

Universidad Fidelitas, Costa Rica — 2016 – 2018

LANGUAGES

Spanish (Native) | English (C1 – Advanced) | Russian (Basic)